

Automation platform Chef goes 100 per cent open source

Chef, the popular automation platform for DevOps, has decided to go 100 per cent open source and include all of its software under the Apache 2.0 licence.

Chef CEO Barry Crist wrote in a blog post: “Going forward, we are doubling down on our commitment to OSS development as we extend our support for the needs of enterprise-class transformation. Starting today, we will expand the scope of our open source licensing to include 100 per cent of our software under the Apache 2.0 licence (consistent with our existing Chef Infra, Chef InSpec, and Chef Habitat licence terms) without any restrictions on the use, distribution or monetisation of our source code as long as our trademark policy is respected.

According to CEO Crist, the firm decided to go 100 per cent open after learning from a variety of commercial open source business models.

By going open source, Crist said the firm would be able to focus all its investments and energy on building the best possible products in the best possible way for the community, without having to choose between what is ‘proprietary’ and what is ‘in the commons’.

“There is no better way to build software than in the open, in partnership with individuals and companies who use our stack in the real world,” stated the CEO.

This means that all the software that Chef produces will be created in public repos. Further, Chef will also open up more of its product development processes to the public, including roadmaps, triage and other aspects of the company’s product design and planning process.

To provide enterprises with a more streamlined way to deploy and update their software, Chef has introduced a new commercial distribution called ‘Chef Enterprise Automation Stack’.

It will be exclusively licensed and tailored for commercial customers of Chef. However, it will be freely available for non-commercial use, experimentation and individuals.

- September 2 – November 29: Technical writers work with open source mentors on the accepted projects, and submit their work at the end of the period.
- December 10: Google publishes the list of successfully completed projects.

Sonatype partners with HackerOne to make open source safer

Software supply chain management company, Sonatype, has announced a partnership with HackerOne, the leading hacker-powered security platform, to



create a vulnerability reporting platform that will help make open source safer.

The Central Security Project (CSP), as the programme has been called, will bring together the ethical hacker and open source communities to streamline the process for reporting and resolving

vulnerabilities discovered in libraries housed in The Central Repository, the world’s largest collection of open source components.

“When individual developers or ethical hackers try and report a new vulnerability to an open source project they often wait for months to get a response, with no guarantee they’ll ever actually receive one,” said Brian Fox, co-founder and CTO of Sonatype.

“As the stewards of the Central Repository, we saw a unique opportunity to partner with HackerOne to simplify the vulnerability reporting process for all involved and help make open source safer for the world,” he added.

Sonatype has added ‘Report a vulnerability’ links to every project page within the Central Repository and OSS Index. These links will connect individual developers and ethical hackers to the HackerOne platform where they can easily report potential exploits. When vulnerabilities are reported, Sonatype’s security research team will rapidly assess the report and, where appropriate, develop a fix.

HackerOne will communicate with relevant project owners and facilitate CVE assignment. Once a fix has been released, the vulnerability will be publicly disclosed through HackerOne’s Hacktivity page, and the person who reported it will be credited for its discovery and submission.

The programme will initially focus on the Java ecosystem within the Central Repository. The companies plan to expand it to other ecosystems over time.

HackerOne CEO Marten Mickos said, “The CSP brings together Sonatype’s comprehensive repository of open source components with the world’s largest community of ethical hackers. By working together, the entire open source community benefits and software becomes safer for everyone.”

New open source software helps researchers evaluate sensor signals quickly and efficiently

Researchers at Saarland University, Germany, have developed a free data processing tool that allows rapid evaluation of cyclic sensor signals, pattern recognition and data visualisation when processing huge data sets.

The software package – called DAVE – represents the very essence of a large number of research projects carried out by Professor Andreas Schütze and his team of experts in measurement and sensor technology at Saarland University.